

People claiming AI's water usage is scary is a failure of education.

Posted by u/Snow0912ak • 0 points • 27 comments

AI needs a lot of water to cool itself. However it's just evaporating water.

The H₂O isn't being split into H and O. It's just being evaporated. So it will always eventually become a liquid again. It's just a basic change of state. No water is actually leaving the earth.

****This is basic chemistry and 4th grade science.****

Comments

u/Big_Contribution_791 • 2 points • 2025-12-10 21:38 UTC

when did r/conspiracy just become people lacking critical thought or basic education making excuses for the elites?

u/I_Reading_I • 2 points • 2025-12-10 21:01 UTC

Minerals salts and organic matter which you would need to purify out.

Trying to recover 100% of the water would take way way more energy to extract than trying to get like 80% and dump the rest as brine, and so would cost even more.

u/RoswellRedux • 2 points • 2025-12-10 20:58 UTC

The fact that there is a fresh water cycle does not negate the fact that while it is in liquid form, its supply is limited and necessary for living things to continue living. Daily using millions of gallons of fresh, potable water for computer data centers is prioritizing data over life.

u/anonrockefeller • 4 points • 2025-12-10 20:13 UTC

It pains me that you posted this with confidence

u/coyylol • 1 points • 2025-12-10 20:10 UTC

Cool, you're absolutely right.

So where do you replace the millions of gallons from that are diverted and used to cool data centres instead of being used to water crops, provide drinking water and other mundane uses?

u/Snow0912ak • 0 points • 2025-12-10 20:15 UTC

Desalinization plants. We should actually be doing this in water short communities like those in Africa.

Honestly we should have massive desalinization plants all over the world. California should never have water shortages, they are right next to a massive ocean.

u/coyyloI • 2 points • 2025-12-10 20:27 UTC

The whole ecosystem of oceans is based on a salt content of around 3.5% using your own diagram, once you start removing large amounts of water from the ocean and stripping it of the salt, the salt content of the water will slowly reduce and the chemical balance will be affected.

Normally, although the salt doesn't leave the oceans the constant replenishment of water keeps the composition needed for life to persist.

u/Snow0912ak • 1 points • 2025-12-10 20:29 UTC

For every 1000L of water thats 3.5 kg of water. Sell it at 5 cents a kg or store it like Americans do cheese.

u/Economy_Ad8222 • 1 points • 2025-12-10 21:36 UTC

35 kg

u/Snow0912ak • 1 points • 2025-12-10 22:38 UTC

3.5% is 0.035 lol

u/Alex_Draw • 8 points • 2025-12-10 20:09 UTC

This would be great if they were all using seawater and maybe even lake water. But I don't think sucking up thousands of tons of ground water like many of them do is going to be ideal just because of evaporation and the hydrologic cycle and shit. I will admit to having almost failed basic chemistry though.

u/ObviousSinger6217 • 5 points • 2025-12-10 20:14 UTC

Yeah they can't do that though

Too much scale buildup

I think they should shut this idea down, AI is a stupid hill for civilization to die on